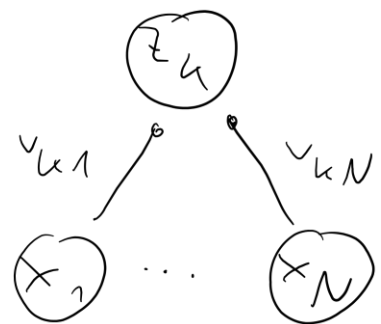


Tuning curves



$$\vec{x} = (x_1, \dots, x_N)$$

$$\vec{V}_k = (V_{ki})_{i=1 \dots N}$$

What stimulus $\vec{x}^*$ is neuron z_k most responsive to?

For static $\vec{x}(t) = \text{const}$,

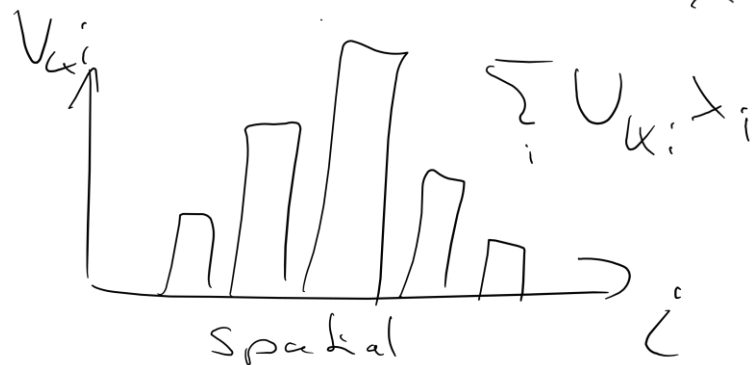
$$z_k \rightarrow \Phi(\vec{V}_k \cdot \vec{x}) \text{ for } t \rightarrow \infty$$

Since $\Phi(\cdot)$ is (strictly) increasing (remember shape of response plot)

$$\vec{x}^* = \underset{\vec{x}}{\text{argmax}} \vec{V}_k \cdot \vec{x} = \underset{\vec{x}}{\text{argmax}} \|\vec{x}\| \|\vec{V}_k\| \cos(\angle(\vec{V}_k, \vec{x}))$$

↳ For fixed stimulus strength ($\|\vec{x}\| = \text{const.}$):

$$\vec{x}^* \parallel \vec{V}_k$$



• often we think of $\vec{V}_k$ as a spatial kernel or a preferred input pattern;

Neuron k is tuned to patterns $\vec{x} \parallel \vec{V}_k$

Temporal dynamics

- For FF-networks, typically much simpler than for recurrent networks
- Each neuron is a low-pass filter of its input $V_k(t)$ (no feedback loops)

$$\left(\partial_t + \frac{1}{\tau_k}\right) z_k = \frac{1}{\tau_k} F(V_k(t) + b_k) =: f_k(t)$$

- Propagation of activity from layer to layer via Green's fct $G(t) = \Theta(t) e^{-\frac{t}{\tau_k}}$

$$z_k(t) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} G(t-t') f_k(t') dt'$$

- Simple example:



- $F_k = [\cdot]_+$ with $b_k = 0$

- $V, W > 0$

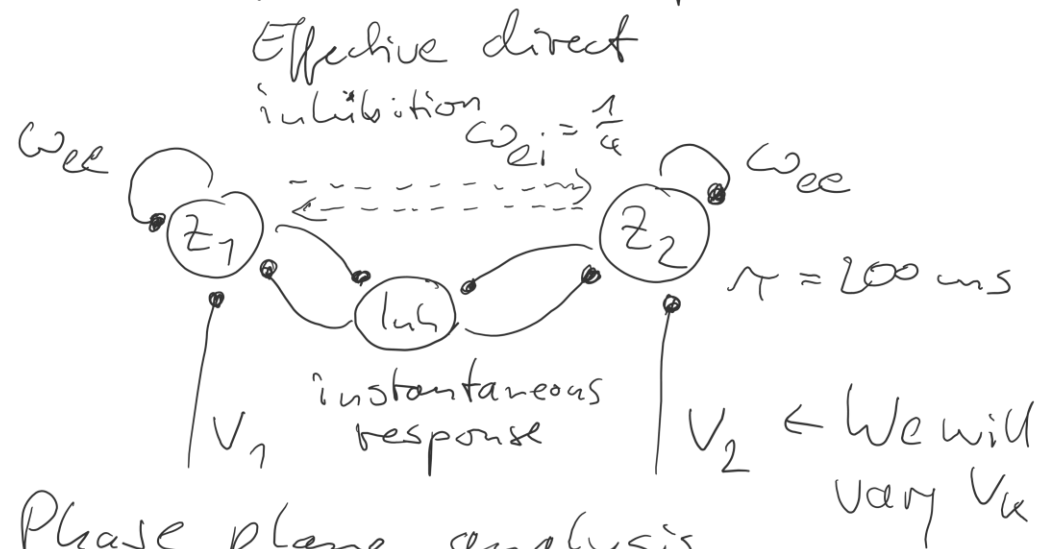
- $x(t) = I \delta(t)$

$$\hookrightarrow z_1(t) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \Theta(t-t') e^{-\frac{t-t'}{\tau_1}} \frac{V}{\tau_1} I \delta(t') dt'$$

$$= \frac{I \cdot V}{\tau_1} \Theta(t) e^{-\frac{t}{\tau_1}}$$

$$\hookrightarrow z_2(t) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \Theta(t-t') e^{-\frac{t-t'}{\tau_2}} \frac{W}{\tau_2} z_1(t') dt' = \dots = \text{Diff. of exp.}$$

Competing excitatory populations



• Phase plane analysis

• Several scenarios

• $V_1 = V_2 = 4$ (weak input): Three stable fixed points

• $|V_1 - V_2| > 8$: only one stable fixed point

→ the winner takes almost all activity

• $V_1 = V_2 \geq 4.7$: Saddle-node bifurcation

→ even small differences in the initial state will lead to a winner

↳ Name: "Winner-takes-all network" (WTA)

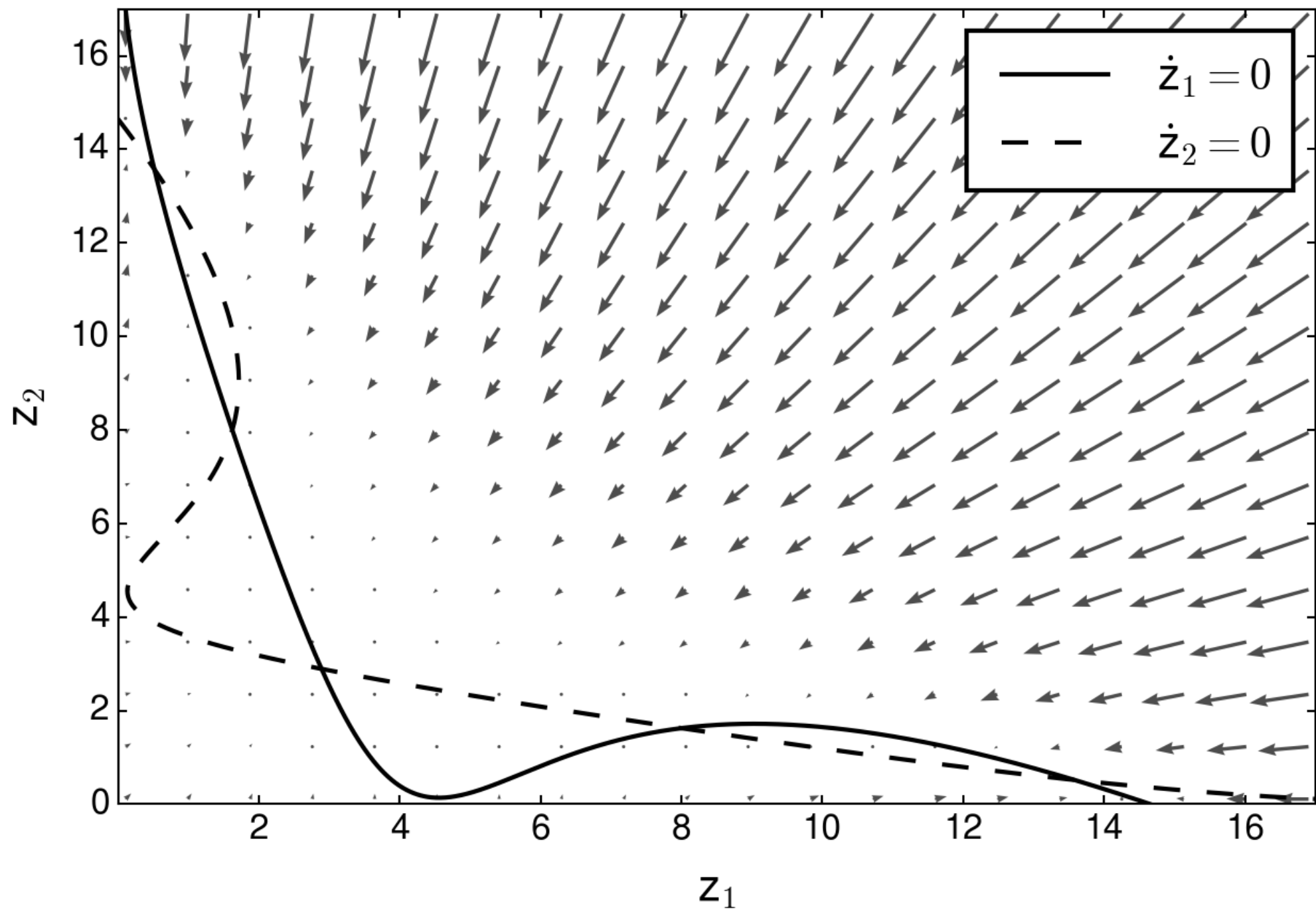
Inh. pop. senses the combined activity

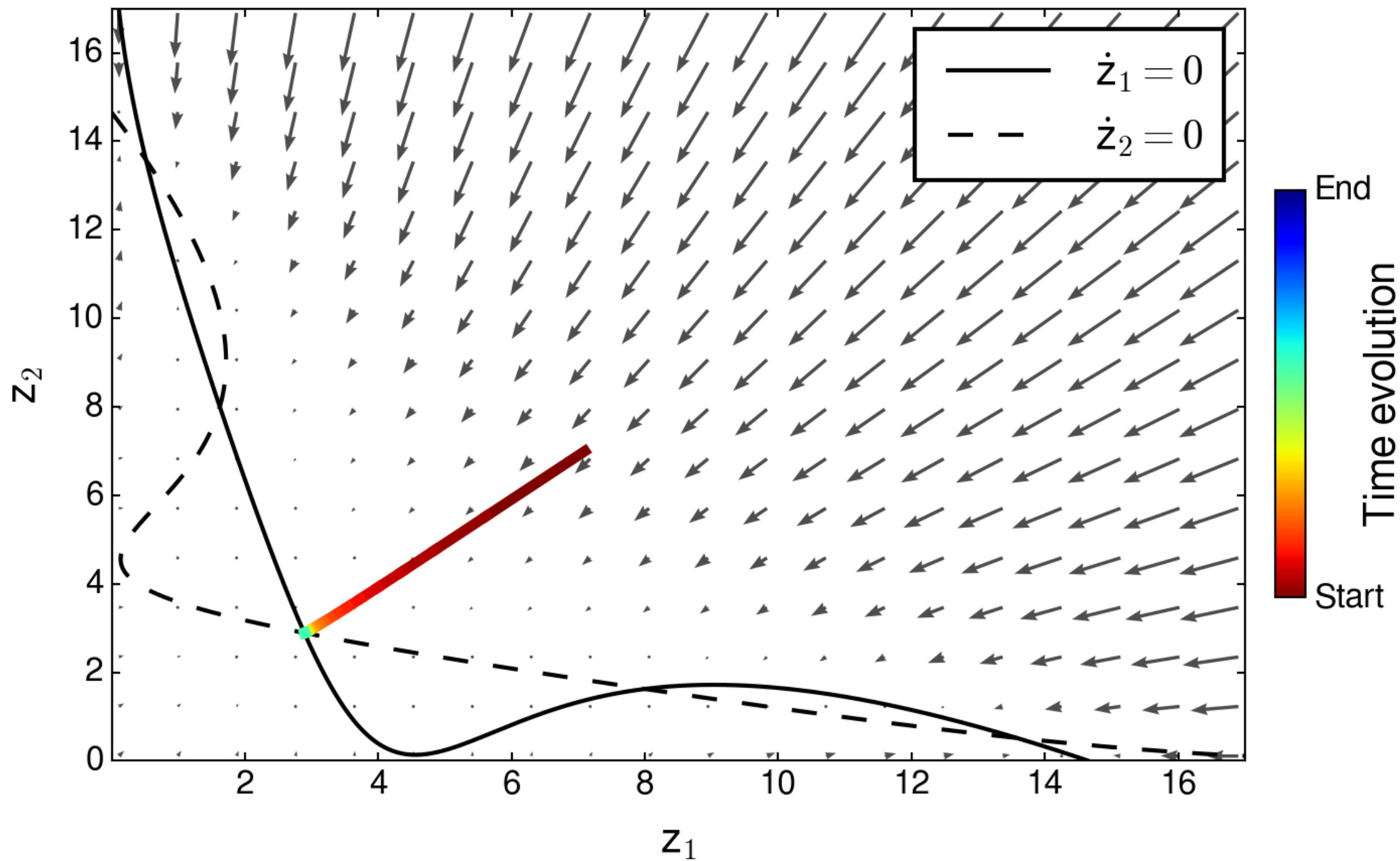
$$\tau \dot{z}_k = -z_k + F(w_{ee} z_k + w_{ei} \underbrace{F(z_1 + z_2)}_{\text{combined activity}} + V_k)$$

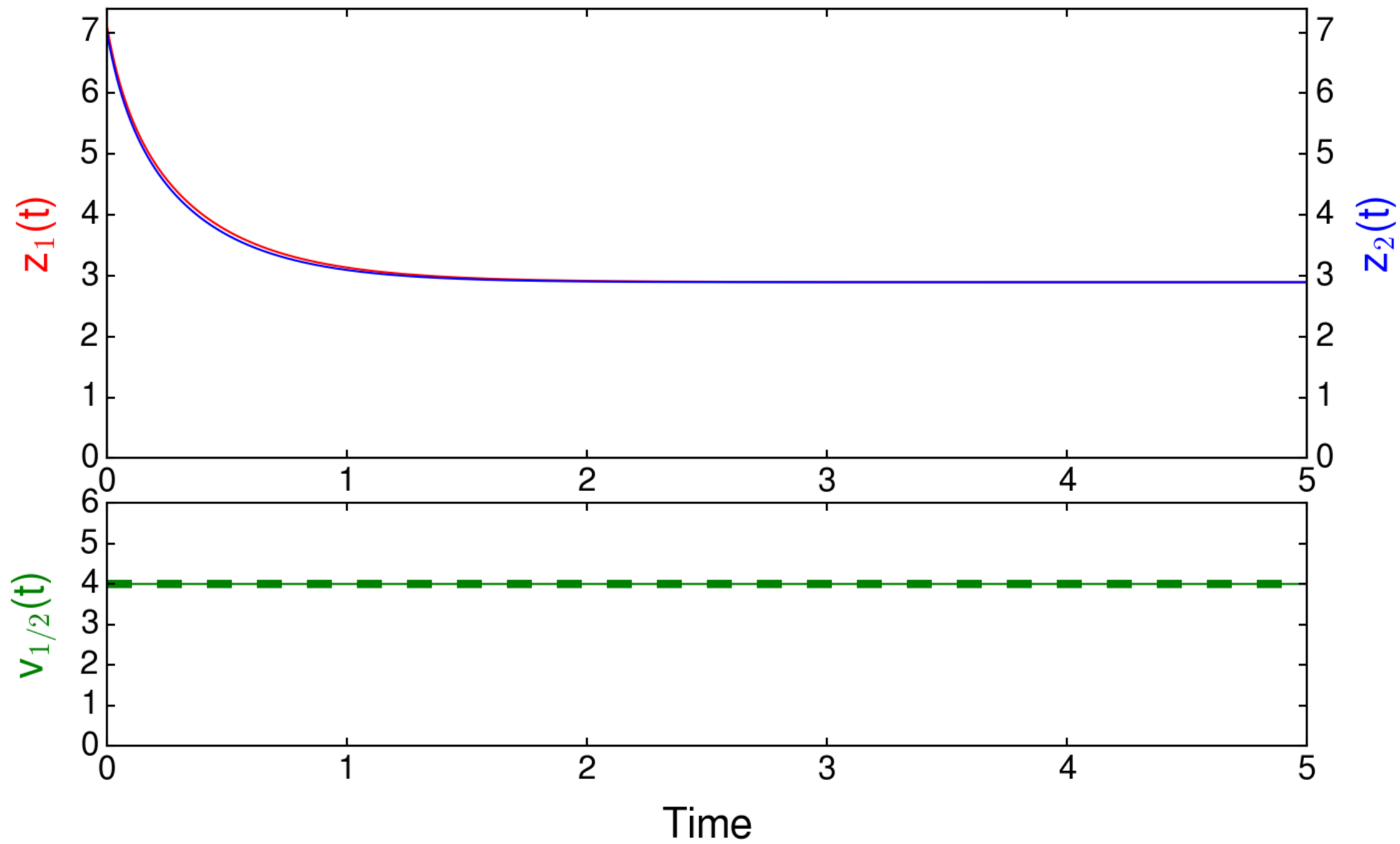
with $F(z) = \exp\left(\frac{a \cdot (z + b)}{L + 1}\right)$ for $k=1,2$
 $L = \frac{1}{4}$ $b = -2$

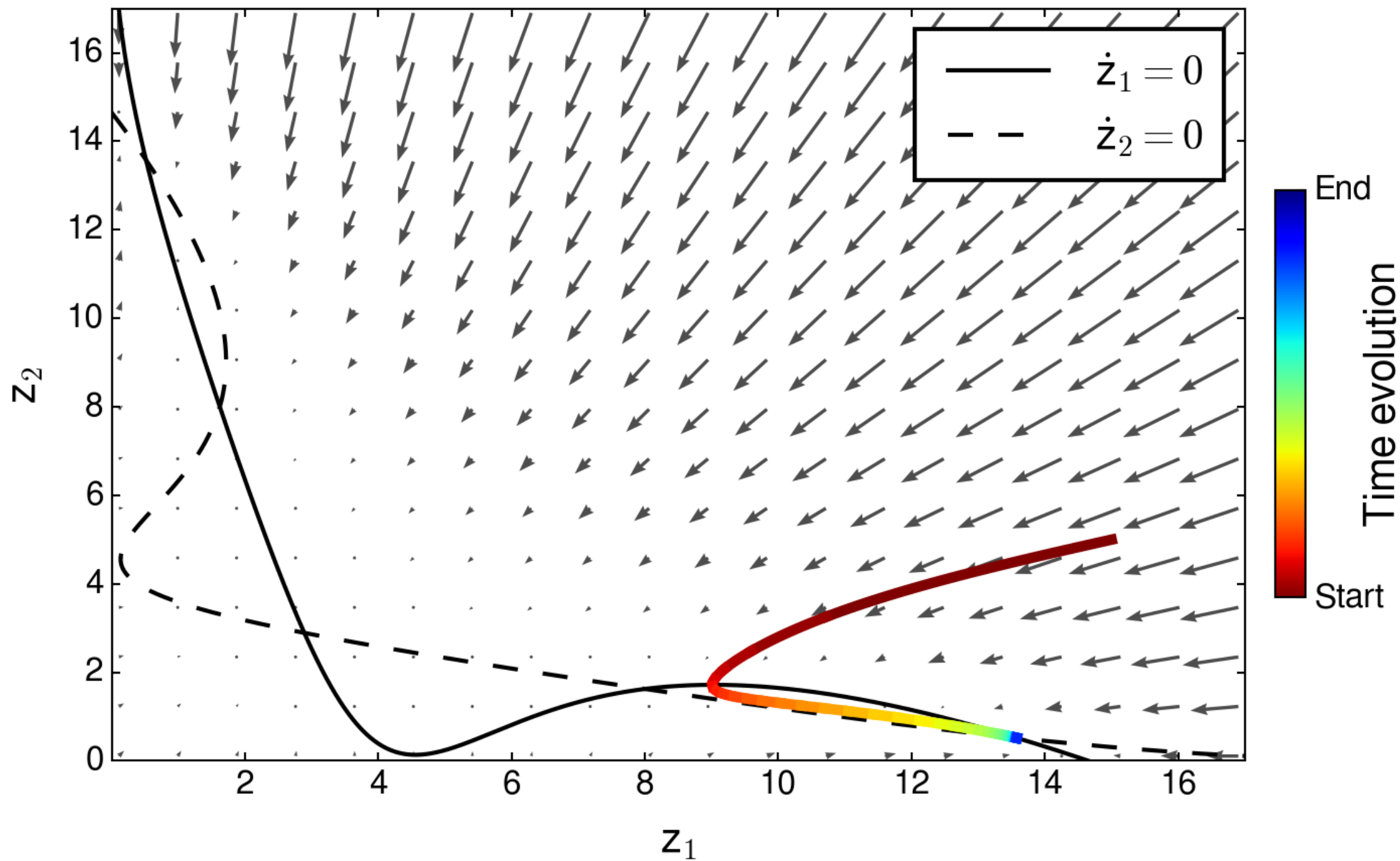
FP1: Both populations fire at moderate frequency

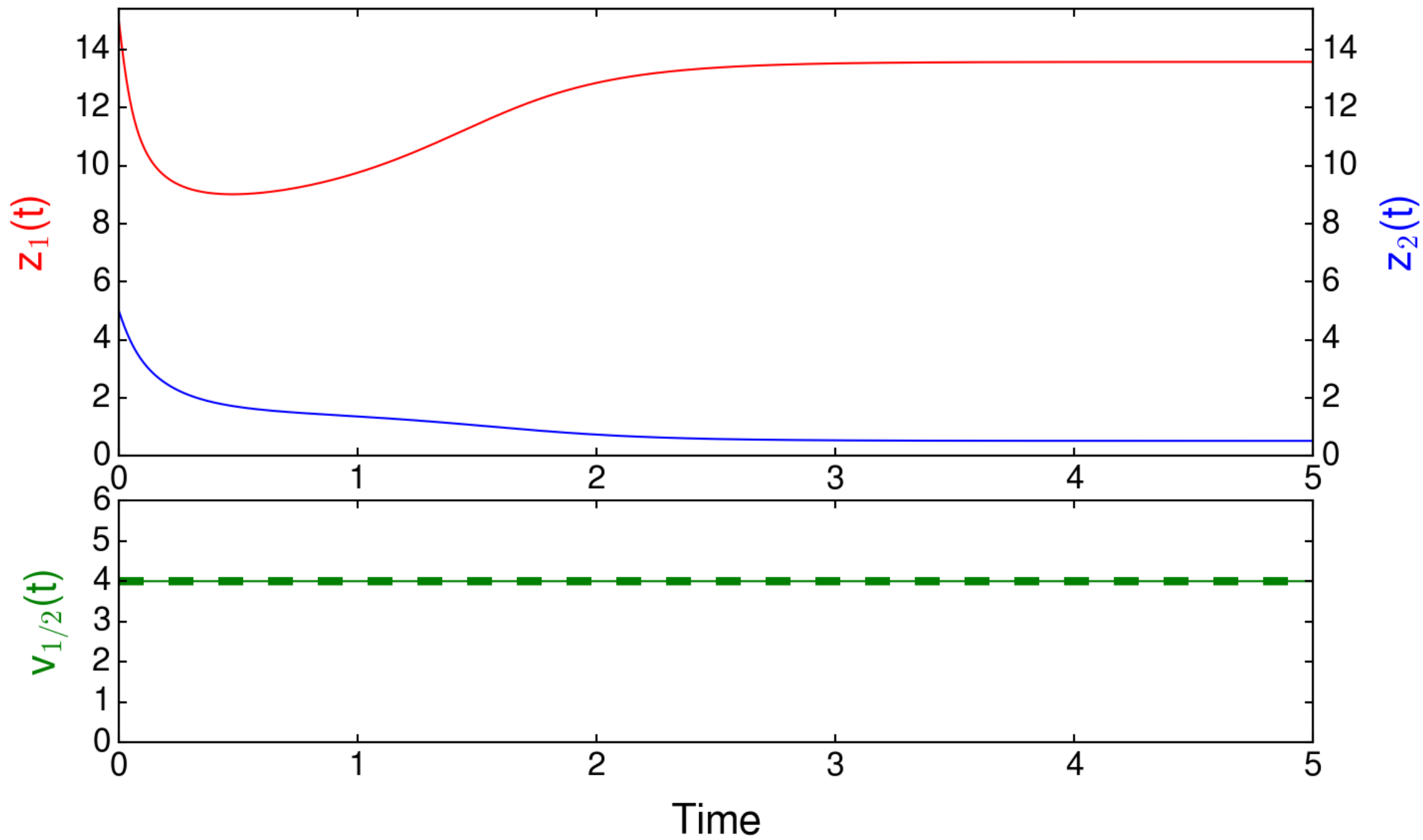
FP2+3: One population suppresses the other

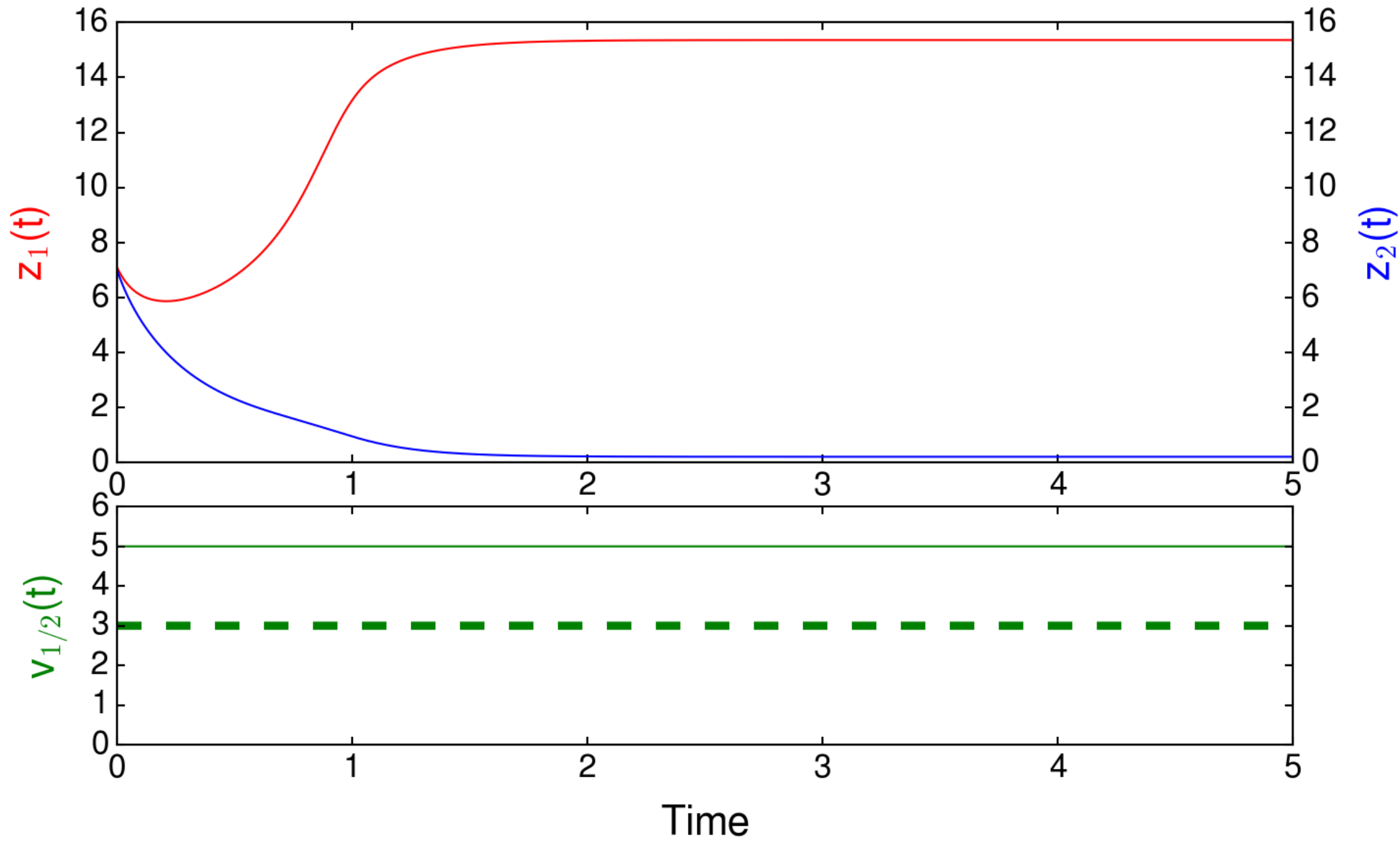


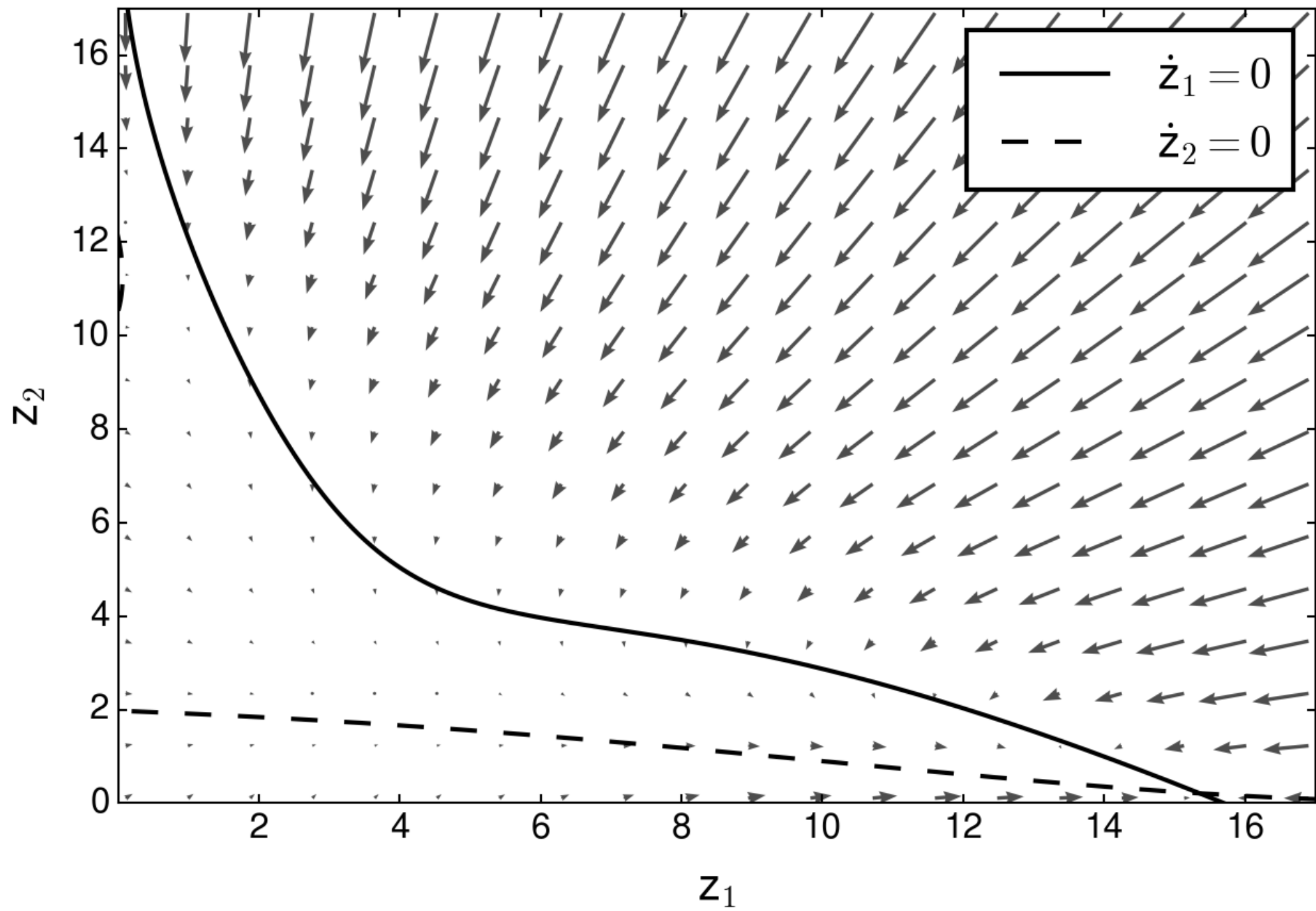


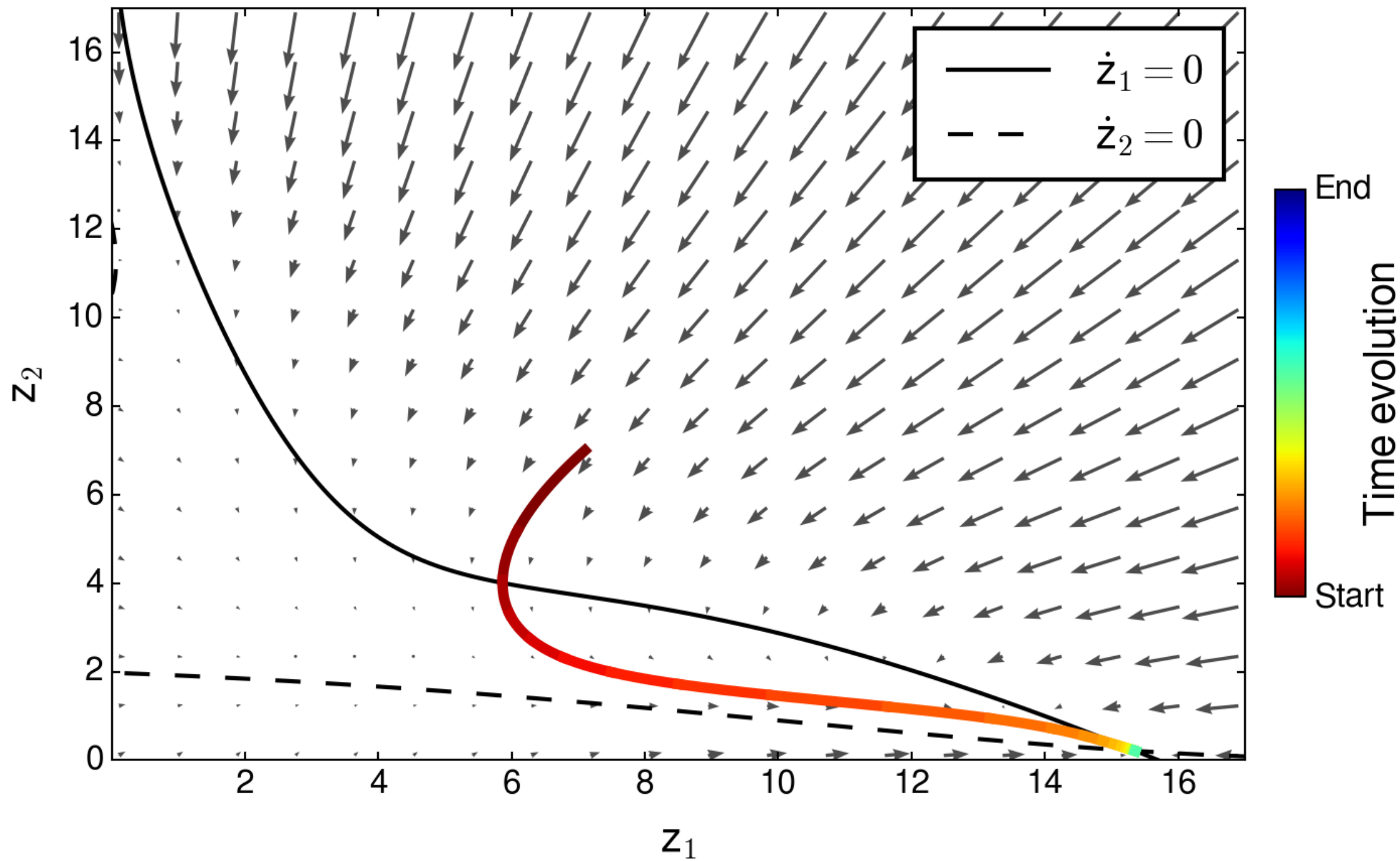


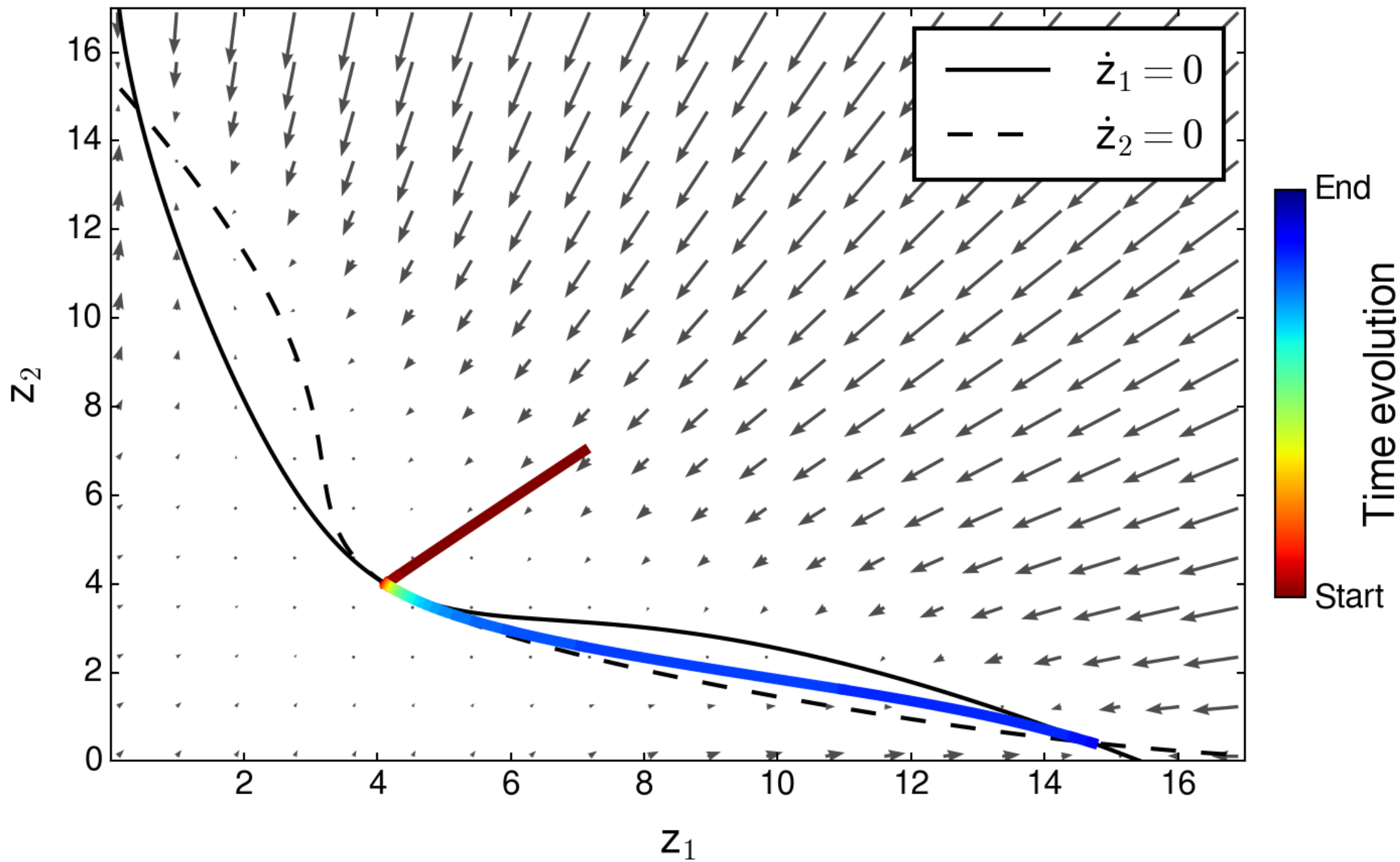


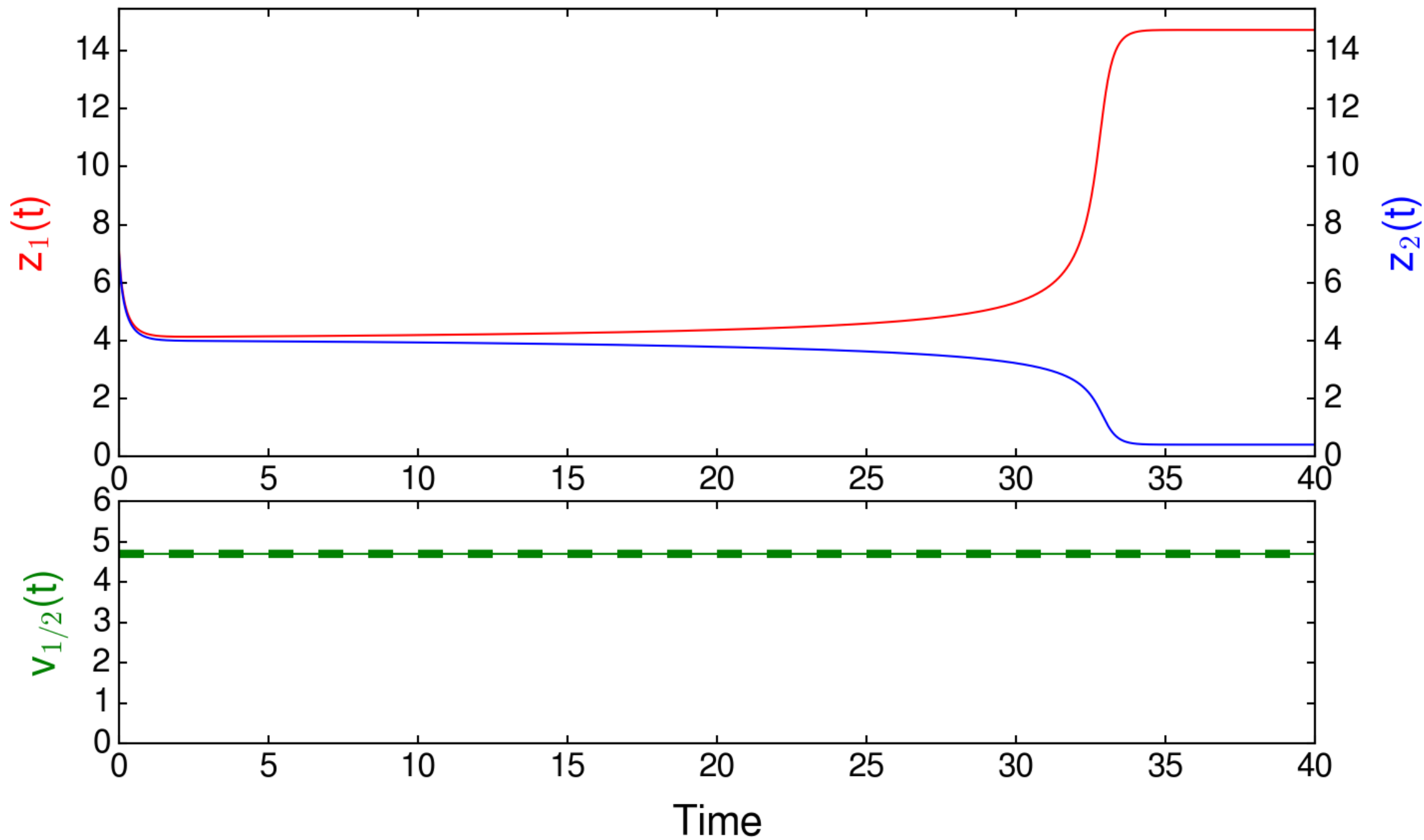




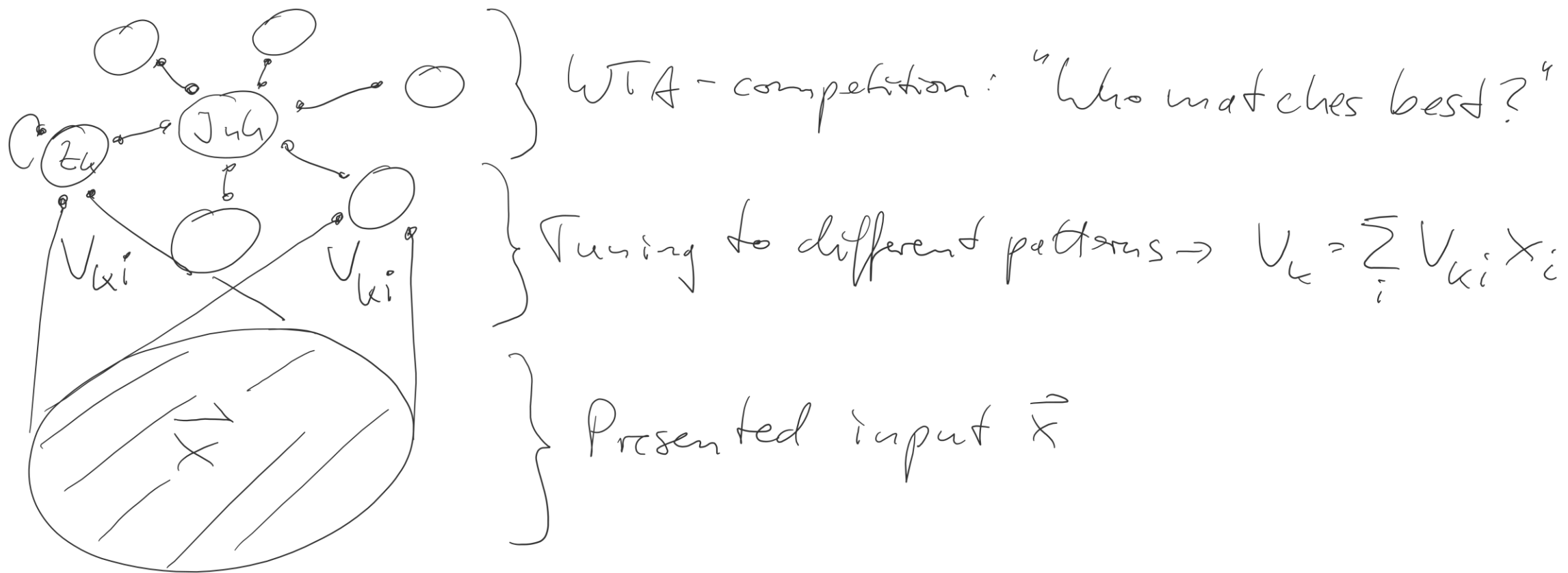








Input integration with multiple WTA-populations



- Reliable detection of inputs (competition)
- Clear-cut output code (winner takes almost all activity).